

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
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OUR FOCUS

**HOW GOD LOVES US and HOW HE IS SO PLEASED
WITH HOW OUR LOVE HAS BEEN MAINTAINED.**

Song of Solomon 2:2 *As the lily among thorns so is my love among the daughters. KJV*

Song of Solomon 2:2 *As the Lily among thorns so is my love among the daughters. BBE*

Song of Solomon 2:2 *Among the young women, my darling is like a lily among thorns! NCV*

IN THIS VERSE THERE ARE TWO ASPECTS OF IMPORTANCE THAT
WE SHOULD ALL **TAKE NOTE OF:**

**THE BRIDEGROOM'S LOVE FOR HIS FUTURE BRIDE – AND HIS
ASSESSMENT OF HER STRONG LOVE FOR HIM.**

FIRSTLY

HOW THE BRIDEGROOM/SHEPHERD (MAN) EXPRESSES HIS LOVE TOWARDS HIS BRIDE-TO-BE (LADY) REGARDLESS OF HER HOSTILE ENVIRONMENT (THORNS & THISTLES) IN WHICH SHE IS SUBJECT TO DAILY.

- From his perspective her environment did not affect his love for her.
- TO HIM IT WAS NOT IMPORTANT AS TO where she came from (a village girl), her ethnicity, where she was born or her family status in community AND IT DID NOT IN ANY WAY DIMINISH OR AFFECT THE QUALITY OF HIS LOVE FOR HER. *He loved her regardless.*
- ▲ THIS IS HOW THE BRIDEGROOM EXPRESSES **HIS LOVE FOR HIS FUTURE BRIDE.**
- ▲ HE SEES **HER AS THE FINEST – THE MOST BEAUTIFUL, THE LOVELIEST** OF ALL THE OTHER ATTRACTIVE MAIDENS.

IN EFFECT HE IS SAYING:

- Even in the midst of the thorns and thistles that daily surround her love for me is unchanged and *SHE is still lovely and the passion of his heart.*
- Regardless of her environment (thorns/thistles) and the daily conflict, hindrance and temptations that she must face, **HE STILL LOVES HER.**
- **TO HIM SHE is still the most beautiful of all other women and she is the one for me.**

DID YOU KNOW

- THAT THIS IS THE **KIND OR QUALITY OF LOVE** THAT CHRIST (OUR BRIDEGROOM) HAS FOR US.

SECONDLY

IT IS THE BRIDEGROOM'S PERCEPTION THAT HIS BRIDE'S LOVE FOR HIM IS STILL VERY STRONG AND HEALTHY AND HE IS CONTENT.

- ▲ HER LOVE FOR HER BRIDEGROOM WAS NOT AFFECTED OR LESSENED BY HER ENVIRONMENT.
- Those thorns that prick, hurt, and are determined to restrict proper growth **did not damage or negatively affect HER LOVE FOR HER MAN.**
- She did not waver in **her love for her lover** and remains steadfast in that love for him.
- Her bridegroom **still delights her and is comforted and reassured in the knowledge** that he has not changed in his love for her.

THE MESSAGE FOR US IS:

1. THAT GOD CONTINUES TO LOVE US REGARDLESS OF WHAT WE HAVE BEEN THROUGH IN LIFE – HIS RELATIONSHIP TO US IS A LOVE RELATIONSHIP, **AND**
2. THAT WE DO NOT ALLOW OUR ENVIRONMENT, THOSE EVENTS AND CIRCUMSTANCES THAT SURROUND OUR DAILY LIVES (both good or bad) **TO AFFECT THE QUALITY AND INTENSITY OF OUR LOVE FOR CHRIST – OUR LOVER – OUR SHEPHERD-BRIDEGROOM AND**
3. THAT WE SHOULD MAKE EVERY EFFORT TO KEEP OURSELVES IN THE LOVE OF GOD **AND ALLOWING OUR LOVE TO GROW STRONGER AND MORE PASSIONATE.**

Jude 21 Keep yourselves in God's love as you wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you to eternal life. NIV

4. SEEING OUR LOVE GROW

- WE ARE INSTRUCTED TO ADD TO YOUR BROTHERLY KINDNESS (Philadelphia love) - GOD'S LOVE (AGAPE) – which means allowing our love to grow in both quality and strength.

2 Peter 1:7 Greek words for "love" are agape (ἀγάπη) and philia (φιλία) for deep friendship and affection.

2 Peter 1:7 and in the affection for the brethren (add) the divine love; Kenneth S. Wuest

2 Peter 1:7 "... [develop] brotherly affection, and in [exercising] brotherly affection [develop] Christian love. AMP

THIRDLY

HIS HEART HAS BEEN CAPTURED/STOLEN (ravished) – HELD HOSTAGE BY HIS BRIDE'S BEAUTY AND LOVELINESS.

Song of Solomon 4:9 You have captured my heart, my sister, my bride. You have captured my heart with one glance of your eyes, with one jewel of your necklace. HOLMAN

Song of Solomon 4:9 You have stolen my heart, my sister, my bride! You have stolen my heart with one glance of your eyes, with one jewel of your necklace. NET

Song of Solomon 4:9 Thou hast ravished my heart, my sister, my spouse; thou hast ravished my heart with one of thine eyes, with one chain of thy neck. KJV

THIS IS HOW THE BRIDEGROOM VIEWS HIS BRIDE.

* SHE IS **SO BEAUTIFUL**, HIS DARLING, **BEAUTIFUL** BEYOND WORDS.

* **HER LOVE IS SO SWEET – IT'S BETTER – IT DELIGHTS ME – IT HOLDS ME IMPRISONED** (holds me as a **hostage**).

Song of Solomon 4:1 "You are beautiful, my darling, beautiful beyond words....." . NLT

Song of Solomon 4:9-10

9 You have captured my heart, my treasure, my bride. You hold it hostage with one glance of your eyes, with a single jewel of your necklace.

10 Your love delights me, my treasure, my bride. Your love is better than wine, your perfume more fragrant than spices. NLT

SUMMARY

* LET US **KEEP OURSELVES IN LOVE WITH JESUS.**

* **LOVING HIM WITH INCREASING LOVE.**

* **OUR LOVE FOR HIM** TO GROW AND BECOME MORE NOW THAN IN AN EARLY STAGE OF OUR CHRISTIAN LIFE.

* LOVE IS MEANT TO BE AN AMAZING JOURNEY OF DISCOVERY OF ITS EVER-INCREASING BEAUTY AND NATURE.

Amen – Ps Barry